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A guide to using Edits,
Meta's CapCut rival for
short-form video editing

Meta recently released a new video editing app for creators called Edits. The new app is designed to rival ByteDance's CapCut, a popular short-form video-editing app used by many creators.

Meta first shared that it was working on Edits back in January after ByteDance-owned CapCut was removed from U.S. app stores when the TikTok ban momentarily went into effect. Although the app has since come back online and is available to download, TikTok's future in the U.S. remains uncertain, so Meta is ready to capitalize on CapCut's possible absence in the future with its new Edits app.

IMAGE CREDITS: META

We've created this guide to walk you through the app and the different features it offers, and we provide an overview of how it compares to CapCut.

How to get started with the app



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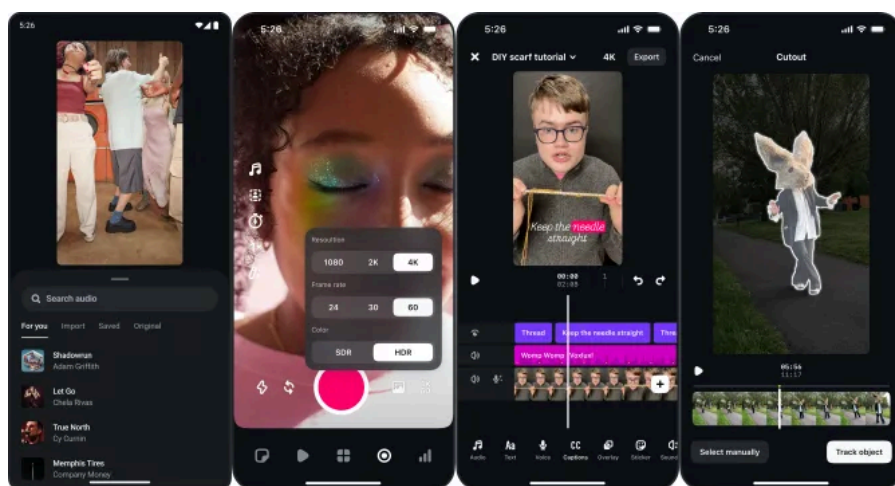
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Edits is available to download on both [iOS](#) and [Android](#). Once you download the app and open it, you will be asked to log in with your Instagram account.

From there you will see five main tabs: Ideas, Inspiration, Projects, Record, and Insights. The Ideas tab offers creators a space to jot down ideas for new videos and save reels to a collection, and the Inspiration tab features a hub for discovering trending audios and other popular reels.

The Projects tab is where creators can store and revisit the videos they currently have in progress. This tab is also where creators can upload videos from their phone's camera roll. The Record tab lets creators start filming video content right within Edits. Lastly, the Insights tab gives creators an overview of how their content is performing by surfacing metrics like views, reach, and follower counts.

Tools and features available on Edits



Green screen: Replace and edit the background of your videos with one tap.

- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines



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Timeline: Precisely arrange and adjust clips.

Captions: Add automatic captions to your videos in multiple languages.

Audio library: Add music from Instagram's library to your videos.

Cutouts: Isolate specific objects with precision tracking.

Animate: Turn static images into videos using AI.

Apply all: Apply filters, effects, transitions, and adjustments to all of your clips at once.

Timeline frame rate selector: Convert your video to the frame rate you want in order to enhance playback smoothness.

Alignment guides: Ensure viewers can see the important parts of your video when posted and accurately position text, emoji, or other elements.

Beat markers: Add auto-detected beat markers to help you align clips, text, and overlays with audio when editing.

Filters: Choose from 30 different filter options to add a unique look to your videos.

Transitions: Choose from 30 different transitions to connect different video clips in a seamless way.

Teleprompter: Follow your written script while recording.

Restyle: Use AI to change the look and style of your video with a library of presets.

Keyframes: Animate the position, rotation, and scale of clips.

Cut Silences: Automatically remove unwanted silence from reels.

Import Audio from Files: Add your own unique sounds directly into edits.

Clip Preview: Preview clips while you're recording from the camera.

How does Edits differ from CapCut?

While both Edits and CapCut are great options for editing short-form videos, there are some differences between the two services.

CapCut offers more robust editing options, including AI features, than Edits does. Of course, this can be expected since Edits is a lot newer than CapCut. Meta will likely continue to build out Edits over the next months and years, so we can expect to see more advanced functionality in the future.

It's also worth noting that CapCut has a more extensive music library compared to Edits.

Another difference is the fact that Edits currently doesn't have a subscription offering (for now), but CapCut does. While CapCut offers a free version, some of its advanced tools are locked behind a paid subscription. Edits is free to use, but this will likely change in the future, as Instagram head [Adam Mosseri has stated](#) that later versions of Edits may include paid features.

In addition, while CapCut is available on the web, Edits is mobile-only. However, this could change in the future.

Update: This story originally ran in May and is updated regularly with new information.

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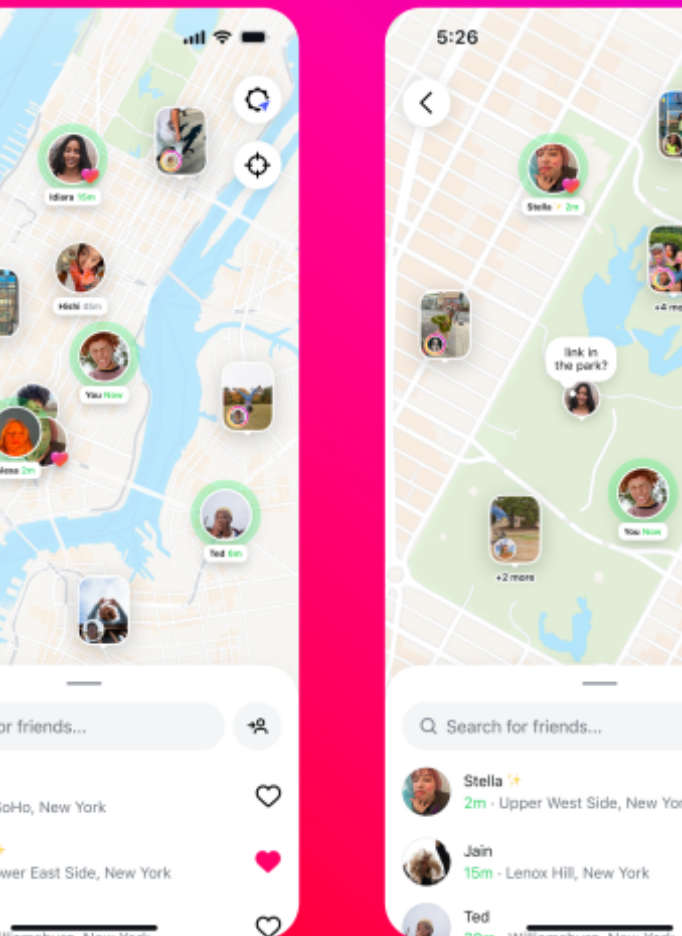
Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’

Aisha Malik — 7:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Instagram is rolling out Instagram Map, a new feature that lets users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content. The Meta-owned social network is also launching reposts, and making its “Friends” tab in Reels available globally.

With its new map feature, Instagram is copying yet another popular feature from Snapchat, after cloning the app’s core Stories functionality [back in 2016](#). Instagram is coming for Snap Map’s crown, a feature that recently surpassed 400 million monthly active users and remains one of the app’s core offerings.

Instagram notes that location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map, and a user’s location only updates when they open the app, meaning it doesn’t provide real-time location updates. Snap

IMAGE CREDITS : INSTAGRAM

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Map, on the other hand, allows users to choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

It’s worth noting that Instagram does offer [real-time location sharing via DMs](#) (direct messages). However, unlike Apple’s Find My and Snap Map, which let you share your location with others indefinitely, Instagram only lets users do so for up to one hour.

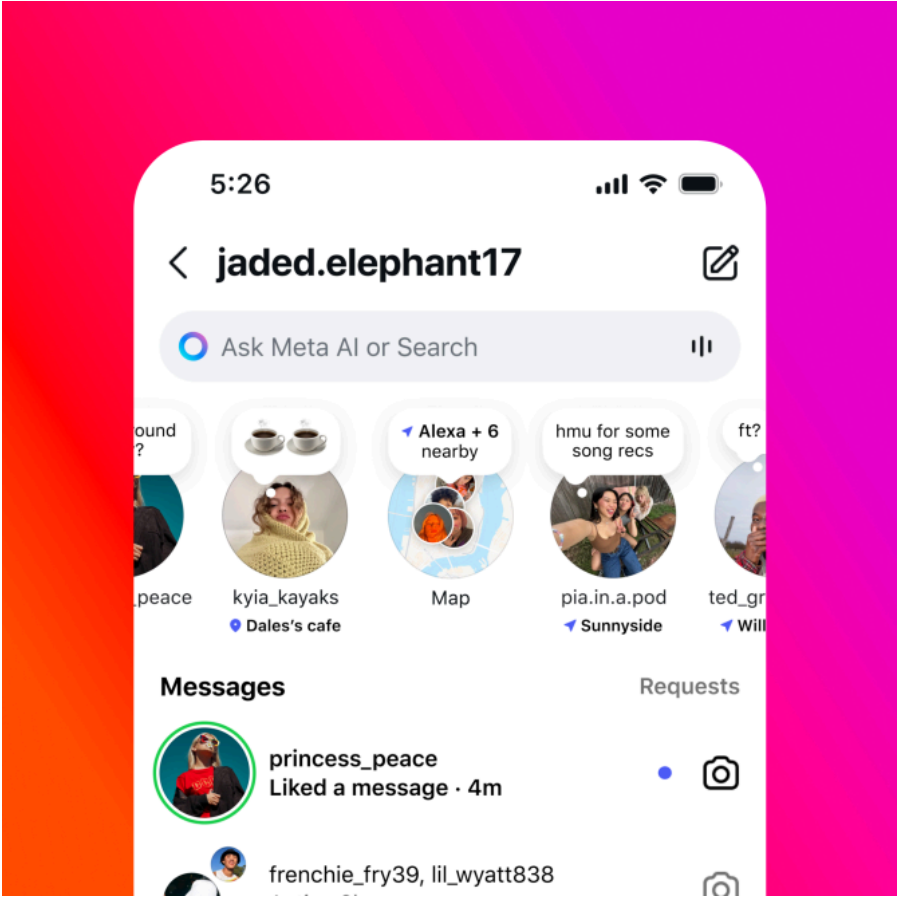


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Instagram says the new map feature will make it easier for friends to coordinate and link up for hangouts. It also lets users explore location-based content that their friends and favorite creators have

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feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, users can now post these short updates on the map.



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Although Instagram is certainly taking on Snapchat with this new feature, it also has the opportunity to appeal to people who were fans of [Zenly](#), a social map app that Snap acquired and then shut down in 2023.

The new map feature is launching in the United States starting Wednesday, with broader global availability coming soon. Users can find the Instagram Map at the top of their DM inbox.

The launch doesn't come as a surprise, as [Instagram was spotted developing](#) the map feature last year.

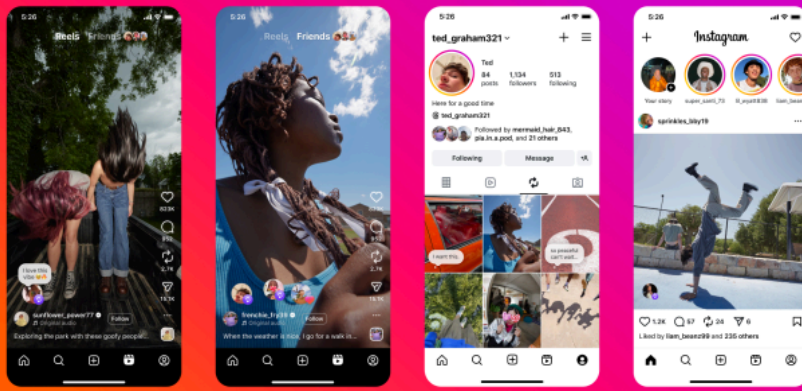


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

As for the new “Reposts” feature, Instagram is taking a page out of [TikTok’s book](#) while also creating its own version of the popular “retweet” function from Twitter (now X).

This feature lets Instagram users repost public reels and feed posts. These reposts may show up in their friends’ feeds and will also be displayed in a new “Reposts” tab on their profile. Instagram says the new feature gives users a way to share their interests with others and also offers creators the opportunity to reach a wider audience.

To repost a reel or post, users tap the repost icon. Users can also choose to add a note to the repost by typing into the thought bubble that appears on screen and pressing save.

Regarding the new “Friends” tab in Reels, Instagram launched it in the United States earlier this year and is now making it available globally. The tab lets you see public reels that your friends have liked, commented on, reposted, and created.

For users who want to browse and interact with content privately, Instagram is rolling out the ability to opt out of having content you’ve engaged with shown in the friends tab.

Users can hide their likes, comments, and reposts from the tab. Additionally, they can choose to mute

likes, comments, and reposts from specific people they follow.

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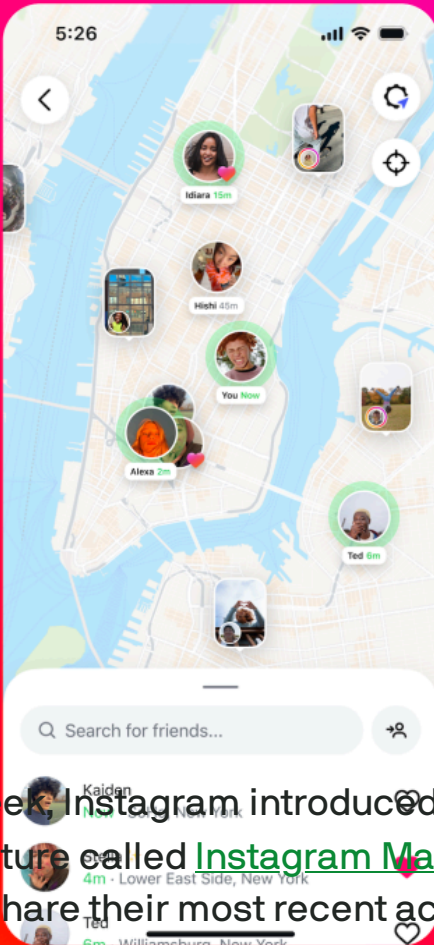
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How to use Instagram Map and set your location-sharing preferences

Aisha Malik — 1:05 PM PDT · August 7, 2025



This week, Instagram introduced a new Snap Map-like feature called [Instagram Map](#) that lets U.S. users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content.

If you decide to turn on your location on Instagram Map, your location only updates when you open the app or have it running in the background, meaning it doesn't provide continuous, real-time location updates. This is different from Snap Map, which lets users choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

Meta says location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map. Following [concerns](#) around safety, [Instagram head Adam Mosseri](#) reassured users that the feature is opt-in, and noted that some people are “confused” about how the feature works.

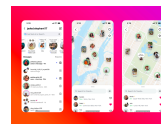
For instance, people are accessing the feature and then seeing the map populated with the location information of some users. This is because the feature automatically pulls in location tags from

IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

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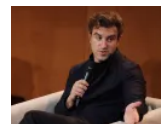
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recently posted Stories or Reels that include a tagged location.

It's worth noting that this isn't new, as Instagram already had location tags visible to users in its map view. However, the new Instagram Map feature makes this information a lot easier to access. The new feature might make you rethink whether you want to post your Stories and Reels with location tags (especially if you're still at the location).

For those who want to ensure their location is turned off on Instagram Map, we'll walk you through the steps below.

How to access Instagram Map

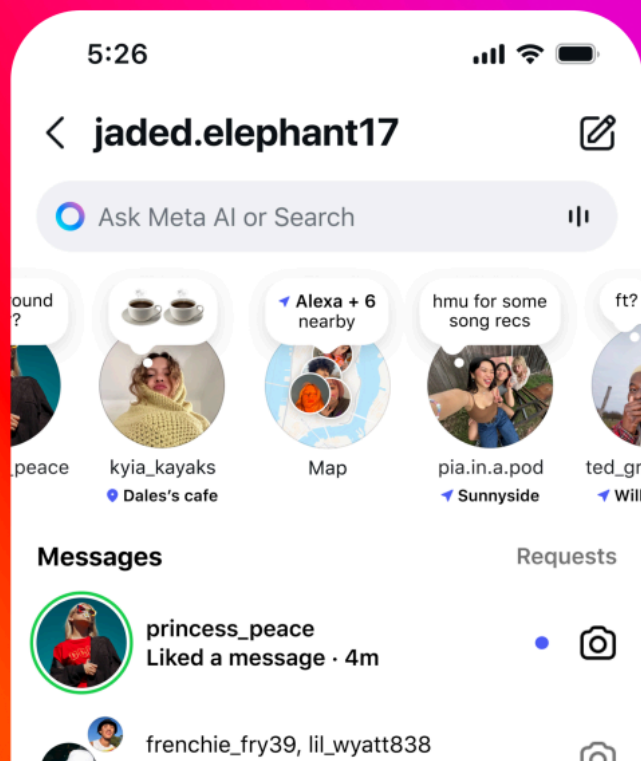


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

To access the new feature, you need to navigate to your DMs page (direct messages) and tap the new “Map” option at the top. If it's your first time accessing the feature, you'll likely see a pop-up message notifying you about the new Map.

The pop-up will tell you that no one can see your location until you share it with them, and that you can change your settings at any time.

How to set your location-sharing preferences

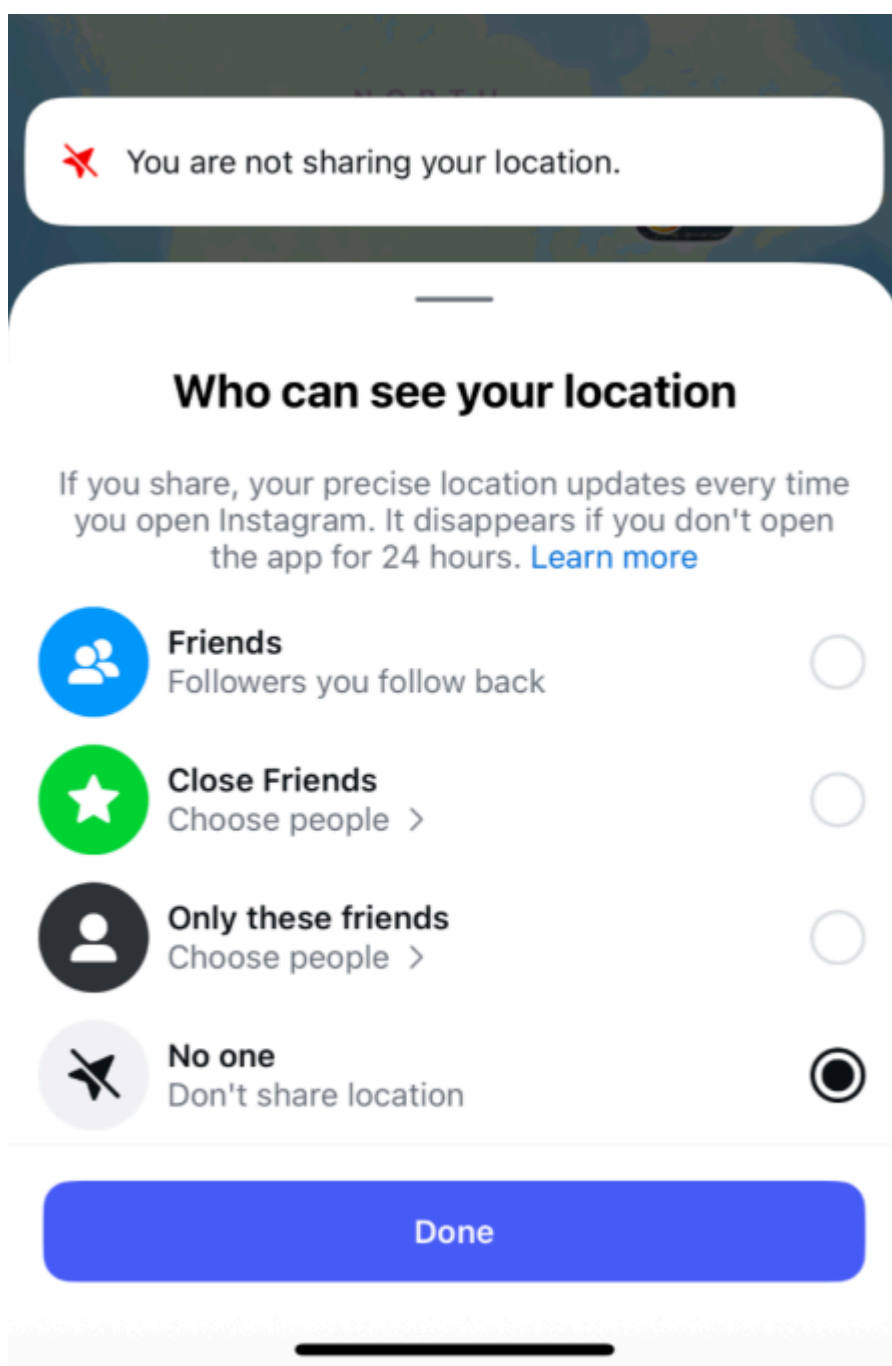


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

The first time you open Map, you will see a page that reads “Who can see your location.” From there, you can choose to share it with your Friends (followers you follow back), your Close Friends list, select users, or no one.

To change your preferences, you need to click on your profile, tap the settings option in the top-right corner, select the “Story, live and location” option, and then tap the “Location sharing” button. Here, you will be able to change your settings.

Note that if you have location sharing turned off, others can still share their location with you, which means you’ll be able to see them on the Map.

How to use Instagram Map

When you open the app, you will see the locations of friends who have shared their location with you. You will also see location-based Stories and Reels from people you follow.

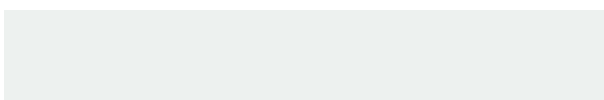
For example, if your friend attended a nearby music festival and posted a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator you follow posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you’ll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

You will still see location-based content on the Map even if you have your location turned off.

You also can leave short, ephemeral messages, or “Notes,” on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are the short messages that currently appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, you will now see these posts on the map if they’re shared with a location.

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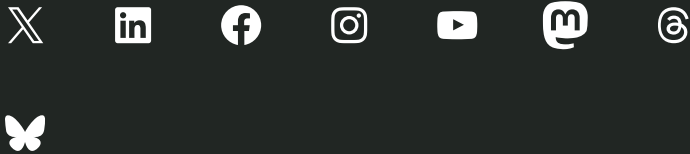
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